

Rachna Jindal

Navigating the Financial Landscape with Purpose and Innovation at Yara Fertilisers

An accomplished financial leader, Rachna Jindal, the CFO of Yara Fertilisers, has carved a remarkable career path, showcasing strategic financial acumen and a steadfast commitment to fostering sustainable growth. In this exclusive feature, we explore the nuances of her leadership, industry insights, and the innovative approaches driving Yara's success.

Can you share your professional journey?

My professional journey has been profoundly fulfilling, marked by substantial personal and professional growth. Rooted in strong values, I have earned credibility throughout this expedition, while my passion for my work has been a driving force, compelling me to consistently challenge myself and take on diverse roles. I consider it a privilege to have collaborated with progressive organizations alongside talented teams, contributing meaningfully to the growth of the entities I have been fortunate to be a part of. These experiences have led me to my current role as CFO at Yara Fertilisers, a position that I hold with great pride. While I recognize there is still much to learn, my aspirations continue to expand, propelling me towards ongoing growth and development.

As a woman in a leadership role in what is primarily a male bastion, what challenges have you faced in your career and how have you overcome them?

Undoubtedly, women encounter numerous challenges while aspiring to and excelling in leadership positions. How we perceive and respond to these challenges is pivotal.The presence of critics and the imposition of additional challenges served as inspiration for me to actively develop my skills. Embracing these hurdles, I actively enhance my capabilities to rise above them. My unwavering belief in the transformative power of diversity drives me to confront challenges head-on. Overcoming such obstacles demands a blend of determination, continuous learning, and the cultivation of robust professional networks. Our commitment to prioritizing meritocracy, fostering collaboration, and advocating for inclusivity has been crucial in establishing a workplace that genuinely values and celebrates diverse perspectives.

What financial strategists have you implemented at Yara Fertilisers to drive growth and navigate industry challenges?

At Yara, our approach is centred around the farmers, and our mission is to responsibly feed the world while protecting the planet. Yara's core values resonate throughout our strategies, decisions, and actions. Our financial strategies are intricately aligned with the purpose and vision of the organization.

Within the context of Yara India, our primary objective is to disseminate knowledge about Yara Crop programs, offering solutions to enhance agricultural yield. This initiative indirectly contributes to India's ambitious goal of becoming a 5 trillion-dollar economy. Our financial strategies are designed to drive growth and confront industry challenges, incorporating digital advancements and cost-effective measures. We are actively building capabilities to provide real-time data and fostering a unified organizational direction with common goals. Our unwavering commitment is to maintain a robust financial position, enabling us to navigate market uncertainties successfully.

How do you balance short-term financial goals with long-term sustainability in your role as CFO?

Balancing short-term financial goals with long-term sustainability is crucial. It becomes easier when the 'purpose' is clear, guiding both decisions and actions. We ensure that our financial decisions align with the company's overall strategic objectives. By carefully evaluating investment opportunities, managing risks effectively, and fostering a culture of financial prudence, we strive to achieve sustainable growth.

How do you integrate innovation and technology into the financial management and decision-making processes at Yara Fertilizers?

Innovation and technology play a pivotal role in our financial management and decision-making processes. We continually explore and adopt cutting-edge financial technologies to enhance our analytical capabilities, automate routine tasks, and improve overall financial governance. This not only boosts efficiency but also positions us to adapt to evolving industry trends effectively.

In your role, how do you stay updated on emerging trends and technologies in finance that can benefit the company?

Staying informed on emerging trends and technologies in finance is a continuous process. I engage in industry forums, attend relevant conferences, and encourage our finance team to participate in professional development opportunities. Additionally, we maintain a dynamic learning environment, fostering a culture of curiosity and exploration.

What is your leadership philosophy, and how do you inspire and motivate your finance team to achieve both individual and organizational goals?

My leadership philosophy centers around two key principles: firstly, "leadership is about giving," and secondly, "fostering a collaborative and inclusive work environment." I am committed to empowering my team by providing them with the tools and support they need to excel. Through setting clear expectations, encouraging innovation, and recognizing individual contributions, I aim to inspire and motivate our finance team to achieve both personal and organizational goals.